

His time in this world might be up,
but he had always prided himself
on making a memorable impression.
He had no intention of quietly fading
away without an extremely grand send-off.
Whatever else people might say about him
after he was gone, they would remember
that he had made his departure in style.

Since Leonardo was no longer up and
about, it had become King Francis's habit to
visit him regularly. At this late date, Leonardo
spoke of how "he had offended God and men
by not working at his art" as diligently as he
might have. But there was little remaining
time for regrets.

On May 2, Vasari stated that as Leonardo
was suffering, "the king raised him and lifted
his head to help him and lessen the pain,
whereupon his spirit, knowing it could have
no greater honor, passed away in
the king's arms ..."

